

The NextGen IELTS Guide

IELTS is scored 0-9 across four skills: Listening, Reading, Writing and Speaking. Most universities ask for an overall 6.0-7.0 with no band below 5.5-6.0. Here's how to get there.

Listening (30 min)

- " Practise with a range of accents; predict answers before you hear them.
- " Watch spelling and word limits: small errors cost whole marks.

Reading (60 min)

- " Skim for structure first, then scan for specific answers.
- " Manage time: ~20 minutes per passage; don't get stuck on one question.

Writing (60 min)

- " Task 1: describe the data: trends, comparisons, key figures.
- " Task 2: clear position, 4 paragraphs, real examples, formal tone.
- " Task 2 carries more weight: spend ~40 minutes on it.

Speaking (11-14 min)

- " Extend every answer: give reasons and examples, never one-word replies.
- " Fluency and coherence beat big words used incorrectly.

Score-Boost Strategy

- " Take a diagnostic mock to find your target gap.
- " Sit at least 3 full, timed mock exams before test day.
- " Review every mistake: patterns matter more than raw practice.